Cyrus Castle

BSc., MBCS

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Personal Statement

I am an empathetic and dedicated individual, with excellent interpersonal skills. I have a solid academic background and good experience in the fields of customer service and working with (often disadvantaged or special educational needs) children.

References are available upon request.

Volunteering

2021
2024

Detachment Instructor, *Army Cadet Force*,
Brook Street, Welshpool, SY21 7LA

- Developed strong organisational, interpersonal, and communication skills through consistent work with children typically aged 12-16.
- Worked with several children who had various special educational needs, giving me a better perspective into how they learn.
- Incorporated interactive and interesting activities into lessons to keep cadets engaged and consolidating what they have learned
- Collaborated with my detachment commander to deliver a structured programme of lessons within time frames, such as preparing cadets for weekends away.

Experience (abridged)

2025

Digital Skills Tutor, *Aberystwyth University*,
Penglais, Aberystwyth, SY23 3DB

- Developed a course to teach digital skills in the Lifelong Learning department of Aberystwyth University
- Taught this course flexibly, working around the varying schedules of students from all walks of life, different starting-levels, and with different additional learning needs.

2023
2024

Demonstrator, *Aberystwyth University*,
Penglais, Aberystwyth, SY23 3DB

- During my studies I worked as a demonstrator in the computer science department
- Assisted first and second year students in practicals, helping them debug their code, encouraging them to think abstractly about solutions to tasks, and giving them somebody to sound out said solutions with.

2023
2024

Relief Support Worker, *The Wallich*,
Chalybete Street, Aberystwyth, SY23 1HS

- Used my lived experience of rough sleeping to support the Wallich's clients across residential projects.
- Developed skills such as conflict resolution, trauma informed care, reflective listening and more.
- Provided a proactive presence in projects, responding to emergencies and addressing issues to ensure a safe and psychologically informed environment.

Education

2026 **PGCE + QTS (Computing)**, *Yorkshire Wolds Teacher Training*

2024 **PhD in Education**, *Aberystwyth University*

Project:

- Does perceived curriculum autonomy correlate with innovation in, and cross-curricular integration of, digital education in Welsh secondary schools?

Research Training Modules:

- Principles of Research Design (Distinction)
- Ethics, Plagiarism and Academic Practice (Distinction)
- Qualitative Data Collection and Analysis (Merit)
- Quantitative Data Collection and Analysis (Distinction)

2021–2024 **BSc Computer Science**, *Aberystwyth University*

Grade:

- First-Class Honours.

Awards:

- Highest BEng/BSc Average 2024
- Highly Commended for Work on Major Project 2024

Project:

- A modern foreign language learning app with a focus on supporting teachers and their pupils in England and Wales

Key Modules:

- **93%**, C and C++
- **88%**, Modelling Persistent Data
- **83%**, Programming Using an Object Orientated Language
- **82%**, Special Education Needs (School of Education)
- **81%**, Making Sense of the Curriculum (School of Education)
- **81%**, Software Engineering

2019–2021 **A-Levels**, *Chweched Dosbarth*, Llanfyllin

- **A***, Government and Politics
- **A**, Computer Science
- **A**, Welsh Baccalaureate
- **B**, History
- **C** *(AS-Level)*, Geography

2014–2019 **GCSE**, *Ysgol Uwchradd*, Llanfyllin

- **9 GCSEs A-C**, including English and Maths.

Memberships

2024 **Professional Member**, *British Computer Society*

Certifications

2023 **(Level 3) First Aid at Work**, *Defence Awarding Organisation*

2025 **(Level 2) Powerboat Handling**, *Royal Yachting Association*

Full UK Driver's License

Publications

Atherton, S., Karlinger, P. and Castle, C. R. (2026), 'Policy and Professional Development for Generative AI in Welsh Education', *Wales Journal of Education*, vol. 28, no. 1.